



PERFORMANCE WORK STATEMENT

Administration for Children and Families

Office of Planning, Research, and Evaluation

Tribal Home Visiting Planning, Analysis, and Communication Project (THV PLACE)

Performance Work Statement

for the

Tribal Home Visiting Planning, Analysis, and Communication Project (THV PLACE)

April 2026



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Performance Work Statement (PWS)

for the

Tribal Home Visiting Planning, Analysis, and Communication Project (THV PLACE)

1.0 General

1.1 Introduction

The mission of the Administration for Children and Families (ACF) within the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) is to foster health and well-being by providing federal leadership, partnership and resources for the compassionate and effective delivery of human services. The mission of the Office of Planning, Research, and Evaluation (OPRE) is to study the ACF programs and the children and families they serve through rigorous research and evaluation projects.

OPRE also supports research and evaluation for the Maternal, Infant, and Early Childhood Home Visiting (MIECHV) Program. HRSA administers the MIECHV program in collaboration with ACF, which oversees the Tribal MIECHV program. This acquisition will support research and evaluation activities to answer questions of interest to ACF's Tribal MIECHV program and support effective communication about research findings for decision making and practice at the federal and/or grant recipient level.

1.2 Objective

With the ongoing expansion of the Tribal MIECHV program and new Administration priorities, there is a need for a mechanism to gain quick, initial evidence to guide program and research decision making. There is also a need to maximize learning from existing data and through tailored dissemination that supports research use. The goals of this project are to plan, support, and implement actionable research and evaluation to answer questions of interest to ACF's Tribal MIECHV program and to effectively translate and communicate these research findings for decision making and practice at the federal and grant recipient level. The activities may include planning and conducting research, secondary analyses of data, reviews of the literature, and developing dissemination materials that translate research findings and support practical application and use.

1.3 Scope of Work

The contractor shall furnish the necessary qualified personnel, equipment, materials, supplies, services, facilities, and otherwise do all that is necessary for, or incidental to, the performance of the work set forth below. Activities under this task order may include: 1) implementing quick turnaround studies on emerging topics of interest; 2) conducting focused literature reviews and environmental scans on priority topics; 3) synthesizing and translating research findings for practical application and



use; 4) supporting the development and maintenance of Tribal early childhood learning agendas; and 5) supporting research-practice partnerships to address research questions of interest to home visiting programs in Native communities. Active engagement of key end users will help to ensure the activities answer the priority questions and meet the needs of home visiting policy makers and practitioners.

Offerors responding to this PWS are expected to draw on their own expertise to propose the most effective approach to addressing the tasks and may propose alternative approaches in addition to addressing the tasks as proposed by the government; justification for alternatives (e.g., cost efficiency, etc.) must be provided with any alternatives proposed. The contractor is expected to work with the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) to refine the activities and proposed plans once contract is awarded.

1.4 Background

The Maternal, Infant, and Early Childhood Home Visiting (MIECHV) Program was created in 2010 and reauthorized through passage of the Jackie Walorski Maternal and Child Home Visiting Reauthorization Act of 2022 (§6101 of the Consolidated Appropriations Act, 2023, P.L. 117-328). The program funds evidence-based home visiting programs to affect a range of outcomes including maternal health, child health and development, child maltreatment prevention, and family economic well-being. HRSA administers the MIECHV program in collaboration with Administration for Children and Families. HRSA provides funds to states and jurisdictions and ACF provides funds to tribal entities to develop and conduct home visiting programs.

Tribal MIECHV. The most recent authorization sets aside 6% of MIECHV funding for awards to federally recognized Indian tribes (or consortia of tribes), tribal organizations, and urban Indian organizations. The Tribal MIECHV program has the same goals as the overall MIECHV program. It also has four additional goals:

- Provide high quality, culturally relevant, and evidence-based home visiting services in American Indian/Alaska Native (AI/AN) communities.
- Support the development of happy, healthy, and successful AI/AN children and families through those home visiting programs.
- Expand the evidence base around home visiting programs in AI/AN communities.
- Strengthen coordination among various programs that serve AI/AN children and families, to create more comprehensive early childhood support systems.

In addition to the Tribal MIECHV program, that directly funds programs in tribal communities, many state and territory MIECHV awardees provide home visiting services to Native families. MIECHV state/territory awardees in Arizona, Mississippi,



Montana, Nevada, New Mexico, North Dakota, South Dakota, Washington, Wisconsin, and Wyoming fund tribal organizations to provide home visiting services to their communities. Additionally, home visiting programs in Native communities may be funded and operated through tribal governments, through states, non-profits or other federally funded programs. It is important to acknowledge the many possible programs that could benefit from further research on home visiting in Native communities.

MIECHV Learning Agenda and Efforts to Build Evidence for Home Visiting in Native Communities

The MIECHV Program carries out a continuous program of research and evaluation activities to increase knowledge about the implementation and effectiveness of home visiting programs. ACF and HRSA work together to develop and update the [MIECHV Learning Agenda](#) which is a plan for building knowledge to improve the State/Jurisdiction and Tribal MIECHV Programs, and ultimately, improving outcomes for children and families. The MIECHV Learning Agenda is guided by priority questions which highlight gaps in existing knowledge that are critical to answer in order to improve program performance and impact. Many types of evidence are used to address these questions including information and data gathered through performance measurement, needs assessments, continuous quality improvement efforts, research and evaluation, site visits, grant applications, implementation plans, and stories and experiences shared by communities, awardees, and families. The MIECHV program uses what is learned to inform decision making, technical assistance, and practice, and to identify future learning priorities, all with the goal of improving the MIECHV Program. Through intentional and strategic cycles of building evidence and using evidence, MIECHV aims to maximize learning and impact.

Although home visiting has a strong evidence base that demonstrates impacts generally, less is known about home visiting model implementation and effectiveness in Native communities. Since program inception, OPRE has worked closely with the Tribal MIECHV to expand the evidence base on home visiting in Native populations and to increase the representation of Tribal home visiting programs in broader MIECHV learning. Their orientation has been grounded in the [Roadmap for Collaborative and Effective Evaluation in Tribal Communities](#) (PDF), which serves as a [call to action](#) for ACF to change the narrative on activities related to data, research, and evaluation with Native communities. ACF's respect for Tribal sovereignty, commitment to building data capacity, and support for continuous learning have shaped Tribal MIECHV's approach to data, research, and evaluation.

To help inform federal home visiting initiatives in Native communities, the earliest cohorts of Tribal MIECHV grant recipients were required to engage in research and



evaluation. Initially, they were required to conduct their own rigorous local evaluations ([Meyer & Denmark, 2020](#)) which resulted in a number of evaluation studies to understand and strengthen home visiting programs ([Morales et al., 2018](#); [Morales et al., 2020](#); [Roberts et al., 2022](#)). In 2016, some grant recipients had another rigorous evaluation option available, to participate in the community-engaged mixed-methods evaluation [Multi-Site Implementation Evaluation of Tribal Home Visiting \(MUSE\)](#). The MUSE study team partnered with 17 Tribal MIECHV grant recipients to design a study that would return meaningful findings to partnering communities and to ACF. The study has three aims:

1. Identify and describe primary influences shaping Tribal MIECHV program planning.
2. Identify and describe how Tribal MIECHV programs are being implemented.
3. Explore supports and challenges to home visiting implementation in Tribal communities.

Products from this study include an internal memo for program planning, a report focused on Aim 1 (Salvador et al., 2024, [Understanding Planning for Tribal Home Visiting Implementation](#)), a brief focused on implementation during the COVID-19 pandemic (Salvador et al., 2025, [Continuing Home Visiting Services During COVID-19](#)), and a final report focused on Aim 2 (Sturmfels et al., 2026, [Implementing Home Visiting in Native Communities](#)).

In 2022, the THV program made a change to the data and evaluation requirements for grant recipients. While there continue to be requirements for performance measurement and continuous quality improvement activities, participation in rigorous evaluation is now optional. An ongoing effort, the [CIRCLE-HV study](#) provides opportunities for research driven by the priorities of Native communities and braiding research approaches to understand home visiting in these populations. CIRCLE-HV provides 1) awards for Research-Practice Partnerships to research entities that pursue innovative research and evaluation of mutual interest with home visiting programs that serve Native children and families; and 2) is pursuing a cross-site study co-created with seven home visiting programs. These efforts will conclude in 2027, but there is an interest in continuing opportunities for local Research-Practice Partnerships.

Given the expansion of the Tribal MIECHV program and their commitment to data-based decision making and continuous learning, the current project will conduct actionable research that aids in decision making by building off the many strengths of past projects (e.g., community engaged, Tribally-led, iterative learning across projects) and maximizing benefit from existing data and published research. In addition to the research and evaluation projects that MIECHV has supported, the knowledge base about home visiting in Native communities has grown and it is important to build from that work as well as from federally funded research. It is also



important to honor the efforts of past data collection and maximize what we can learn from those investments.

[ACF's Evaluation Policy](#) demonstrates ACF's commitment to conducting rigorous, relevant evaluations and to using evidence from evaluations to inform policy and practice. The five principles of ACF's Evaluation Policy are: rigor, relevance, transparency, independence, and ethics. It is expected that the work described above will be carried out in accordance with the following principles.

Rigor. ACF is committed to using the most rigorous methods that are appropriate to both the evaluation questions and the populations, circumstances, and settings that are the focus of study; and that are feasible within budget and other constraints. Rigor is not restricted to impact evaluations, but is also necessary in implementation or process evaluations, descriptive studies, outcome evaluations, and formative evaluations; and in both qualitative and quantitative approaches. Rigor requires ensuring that inferences about cause and effect are well founded (internal validity); requires clarity about the populations, settings, or circumstances to which results can be generalized (external validity); and requires the use of measures that accurately capture the intended information (measurement reliability and validity). In assessing the effects of programs or services, ACF evaluations will use methods that isolate to the greatest extent possible the impacts of the programs or services from other influences, such as trends over time, geographic variation, or pre-existing differences between participants and non-participants. For such causal questions, experimental approaches are preferred. When experimental approaches are not feasible, high-quality quasi-experiments offer an alternative. ACF will develop and use methods that are appropriate for understanding a range of populations.

Relevance. It is ACF's policy to integrate existing evidence and opportunities for further learning into all activities. Where an evidence base is lacking, ACF is committed to building evidence through strong evaluations. To be most relevant, ACF will use participatory practices in each phase of evaluation planning, execution, and dissemination as appropriate and feasible. Evaluation priorities should take into account legislative requirements and Congressional interests and should reflect the interests and needs of ACF, HHS, and Administration leadership; ACF program office staff and leadership; ACF partners such as states, territories, tribes, and local grant recipients; the populations served; researchers; and other groups and individuals. Further, evaluations designed, and measurement used under this task order should represent the populations served by ACF. Finally, findings must be disseminated in ways that are clear, accessible, and useful to our audiences; this includes using plain language, adhering to principles of clear communication, and developing products accessible to people with disabilities.



Transparency. ACF values transparency in research and evaluation and is committed to making information about planned, ongoing, and completed evaluations easily accessible.

First, any studies conducted under this contract must be registered with an appropriate registry (e.g., clinicaltrials.gov) prior to the initiation of data collection. Study plans, including analysis plans, should be specified in advance.

Second, ACF is interested in making evaluation data and analyses available for secondary use by other interested researchers. A thoughtful data archive plan will establish procedures and parameters, well in advance of any data collections, to support archiving information and data collected under this task order.

Finally, ACF is interested in ensuring that its research and evaluation work is communicated to a range of relevant audiences throughout the course of project activities. Ongoing and continuous activities are considered essential to a strong communication approach. Audiences that may be appropriate include, but are not limited to: policy-makers, intermediaries, researchers, advocates and opinion leaders, program administrators, training and technical assistance providers, practitioners, and the communities that ACF services. ACF will require contractors to meaningfully engage groups and individuals from the programs and communities involved in studies to improve clarity of presentations, accuracy of interpretations, and effectiveness of external communications activities. ACF is particularly interested in the creation of project external communication plans that identify specific audiences and approaches and products to communicate to those audiences. ACF is also interested in communication plans that use new and emerging media, as well as innovative approaches to communication products that are compatible with the ACF website and other communications platforms.

Independence. ACF's evaluation policy upholds the idea that independence and objectivity are core principles of evaluation. Agency and program leadership, program staff, service providers, populations and communities studied, and others participate actively in setting evaluation priorities, identifying evaluation questions, and assessing the implications of findings to help ensure the relevance of the work. While active engagement of groups and individuals who are invested in the outcomes of evaluation can support relevance as well as the accuracy of program implementation details, it is important to insulate evaluation functions from undue influence and from both the appearance and the reality of bias. To promote objectivity, ACF protects independence in the design, execution, analysis, and reporting of evaluations, as outlined in the evaluation policy.

ACF aims to be informed by the practice and empirical knowledge available to inform such topics as measurement choices, technical assistance, training and site



support, and the contextualizing of findings. Meaningful involvement of groups and individuals in the evaluation may increase the rigor of the activities of the task order itself as well as understanding, acceptance, and utilization of evaluation findings. Groups and individuals who are invested in the outcomes of research or evaluation include agency and federal, state or local program leadership, program staff (both at ACF and at the grantee or other programs being evaluated), service providers, developers of innovations or practices, participants in the programs, and the communities where programs occur. As appropriate, groups and individuals should have the opportunity for input at multiple phases of a project, but this input must be accomplished in a transparent way while safeguarding the objectivity and independence of the study.

Ethics and Data Safety. ACF-sponsored evaluations are conducted in an ethical manner; safeguard the dignity, rights, safety and privacy of participants; and comply with both the spirit and the letter of relevant requirements such as regulations governing research involving human subjects. ACF will expect contractors to meaningfully engage groups and individuals from the programs and communities involved in studies to ensure programmatic, cultural, linguistic and historical nuances are accurately and respectfully addressed from the initial study design, through execution, analyses and reporting.

ACF is committed to ensuring that data collected as part of this contract are maintained and stored securely. For the purposes of this section:

- Personally Identifiable Information (PII) is defined as information that can be used to distinguish or trace an individual's identity, such as their name, social security number, biometric records, alone or when combined with other personal or identifying information, which is linked or linkable to a specific individual, such as date and place of birth, mother's maiden name, and so on.

The Role of Active Engagement for OPRE Projects

OPRE defines active engagement as the intentional involvement of groups and individuals who are invested in the outcomes of the research or evaluation. This should occur in all relevant phases of the project. The purpose of active engagement is to improve the quality, rigor, and relevance of OPRE projects and facilitate the uptake of findings. OPRE seeks input from people with practice and empirical expertise to inform project activities. This includes but is not limited to refinement of conceptual models, developing research questions, measurement choices, evaluation technical assistance, training and site support, the contextualization of findings, and external communication priorities.



To this end, OPRE expects contractors to develop plans and implement strategies to maximize opportunities for active engagement in ACF projects that are appropriate to the goals of each phase of a project's life cycle. Approaches can range from shared ownership of projects (e.g., co-creation) and community based participatory research to consultation for specific activities. Opportunities to provide input shall be considered for all phases of the project from refining research questions to external communication of findings, as appropriate for the scope and goals of the project.

Groups and individuals to actively engage may include but are not limited to service providers; developers of interventions, innovations, or practices; program participants; subject matter experts; federal, grantee, or other program staff; federal, state, or local leadership; groups and individuals in programs' communities; individuals with experience in human services programs; and those in broader fields of study related to human services research and evaluation.

To promote objectivity, ACF protects independence in the design, conduct and analysis of evaluations, as outlined in the agency evaluation policy. Active engagement input shall be obtained in a transparent way while safeguarding the objectivity and independence of the study, to insulate evaluation functions from undue influence and from both the appearance and the reality of bias.

OPRE's Approach to Research and Evaluation with Native Communities

OPRE takes an intentional approach to research, evaluation, and evaluation technical assistance with tribal communities that is aligned with the [Roadmap for Collaborative and Effective Evaluation in Tribal Communities](#) (PDF) and grounded in [ACF's Evaluation Policy](#) to promote rigor, relevance, transparency, independence, and ethics. We design our research and technical assistance to maximize learning from ongoing OPRE activities. We strive to be responsive to a history of trust violations and adhere to tribal cultural principles regarding data that emphasize both protection and benefit. We also utilize the principles of [active engagement](#) to assure that our projects with tribal communities promote opportunities for co-creation of knowledge and incorporate community voice.

1.5 Type of Contract Contemplated

Time and Materials.

1.6 Period of Performance

This contract consists of a Base and three Optional periods. Including all Optional Periods (if executed), the total period of performance for the contract will not exceed 60 months from date of award.



The period of performance for the Base is 60 months (estimated September 30, 2026-September 29, 2031)

The anticipated period for the Optional Periods are shown below, although the Government is not obligated to exercise any Option and the dates below are estimates:

Optional Period 1: 48 months (estimated September 30, 2027-September 29, 2031)

Optional Period 2: 36 months (estimated September 30, 2028-September 29, 2031)

Optional Period 3: 24 months (estimated September 30, 2029-September 29, 2031)

1.7 Place of Performance

The work to be performed under this task order will be performed at the Contractor's address and may include multiple states and localities.

1.8 Recognized Holidays

New Year's Day

Martin Luther King Jr.'s Birthday

President's Day

Memorial Day

Independence Day

Juneteenth

Labor Day

Columbus Day

Veteran's Day

Thanksgiving Day

Christmas Day

1.9 Applicable Documents

- Clear Communications Checklist
- Quality Assurance Surveillance Plan (QASP)
- Plain Language Checklist

2.0 Specific Requirements/Tasks

The Base and Option of this order include similar tasks, and the Option may be exercised multiple times with different Optional Periods. However, the needs for these tasks may vary significantly based on the specific programmatic focus of each Optional Period/CLIN, the particular need of the COR or other federal staff for each activity, and the requirements to complete each individual activity. The Contractor will be provided with specification for each effort within a task when the work is initiated. The Contractor shall be prepared to work on multiple efforts simultaneously, including several simultaneous efforts within a task (e.g., multiple dissemination products, a variety of information sharing efforts, and several expert consultant agreements all within one Optional Period), as well as managing several activities



across multiple open Option Periods. As such, the Contractor shall have capacity, experience, and expertise to provide appropriate support for several concurrent tasks across multiple program areas as well as appropriate management and communication to oversee all of the resulting tasks and efforts simultaneously

Task 1: Project Management and Team Communication

Effective communication between the Contractor and the federal government, coordinated through the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR), and successful management of the project as a whole are essential to the success of this Service Component, and the project more broadly. The need for communication begins at the very start of the contract. **Within 2 weeks contract award**, the Contractor shall initiate communication with the COR and other federal staff to schedule a project orientation to discuss a range of topics, including, but not necessarily limited to, clarification of ACF's interests and objectives for the project, conducting work on an efficient schedule and budget, coordination with other ACF program offices, methodologies to be employed, timelines for early project deliverables, and the challenges anticipated and potential solutions. The Contractor shall send an agenda and any relevant materials to the COR **no less than three (3) working days** prior to the discussion. **Within five (5) working days of the project orientation**, the Contractor shall submit to the COR a memorandum summarizing major decisions reached and follow-up issues identified during this discussion.

Ongoing communication is also necessary to ensure successful completion of this service component, and should be both verbal (e.g., regularly scheduled conference calls) and written (e.g., monthly progress reports). The Contractor shall propose a schedule for bi-weekly meetings to update federal staff on progress and issues. Key Contractor staff, sub-Contractor staff, and/or consultants shall participate as needed to address progress and issues for discussion. The schedule for meetings may be changed as agreed upon by the COR. The Contractor shall submit a proposed agenda for each call **at least three (3) working days in advance of the scheduled date** to the COR for comment. If there are materials that federal staff will need to review prior to the call date, such materials shall be submitted at least three (3) working days in advance of the call date. The Contractor shall submit a summary of meetings to the COR for review and approval **no later than three (3) working days after each regular meeting**.

In addition to the ongoing conference calls, the Contractor shall submit written monthly progress reports throughout the period of the service component, which includes the following information: activities completed and progress on each task for the report month, including expenditure data by task, monthly and cumulative expenditures, and the balance remaining. All IT-related expenses shall be highlighted for ease of reporting. The Contractor reports shall include details related to project performance. Monthly progress reports shall be submitted to the COR monthly, on a regular schedule proposed by the Contractor and approved by the COR and before or concurrently with submission by the Contractor of invoices related to that period of performance.

Task 2: Active Engagement Plan



For the current study, the contractor shall develop an approach, a plan, and implementation strategies that maximize opportunities for active engagement that are appropriate to the goals of each phase of this project's life cycle.

The objectives of active engagement for this contract are to help identify and prioritize emerging questions of interest, to ensure that the planned approach to answer the questions and communication about results benefits from the deep knowledge and perspectives of groups and individuals who are invested in the work.

Groups and individuals to actively engage may include but are not limited to:

- Federal MIECHV staff and contracted TA providers
- Tribal MIECHV Grant recipients and MIECHV awardees and local implementing agencies
- Model developers
- Program staff and program participants;
- subject matter experts;
- groups and individuals in programs' communities;
- those in broader fields of study related to Tribal early childhood and human services research and evaluation.

There are a variety of strategies and mechanisms that can be used to actively engage groups and individuals who are invested in the outcomes of the work conducted under the Base, such as one-on-one meetings, listening sessions, or convening expert work groups, which could be held in person or virtually. Strategies and mechanisms used shall be appropriate for the audience being engaged and for the goal of the engagement. When planning active engagements, all efforts shall be made to maximize use of already occurring opportunities for gathering, such as grant recipient meetings and conferences.

Active engagement may be undertaken as part of any tasks in the BASE and optional services components but will be particularly critical to Task 4: Identifying Priority Questions and Rigorous Strategies, Task 6: Implementing Quick Turnaround Studies, Task 6: Conducting Focused Literature Reviews and Environmental Scans, Task 7: Synthesizing and Translating Research Findings, Task 8: Supporting the Development and Refinement of Tribal Early Childhood Development Learning Agenda. Active engagement may occur during multiple phases of projects but will be particularly important for the conceptualization phases and communication phases.

The Contractor shall provide a plan for active engagement in project tasks and deliverables. To accomplish the goals of including meaningful and appropriate active engagement while upholding the principle of independence in ACF sponsored evaluations, the plan should begin with a clearly articulated rationale for the Contractor's approach to active engagement to guide the entire project and achieve its purpose. This rationale shall guide engagement across all tasks



and any options. The approach to active engagement shall describe the reason for inclusion of the individuals and groups proposed to be engaged, how and when they will be engaged, and how input will be addressed and incorporated to achieve the purpose of the study.

The plan should follow from this approach and:

- delineate the project tasks and activities where active engagement will occur;
- demonstrate how active engagement in these tasks and activities will meet specific goals of this project;
- identify potential individuals and groups who may be involved in the active engagement and indicate why or to what end they will be engaged, how they will be engaged, and the timeline for when the project plans to engage them;
- describe the budget considerations associated with the proposed active engagement; and
- delineate how the plans for active engagement will be refined throughout the project.

For the current study, at a minimum, the following tasks should include active engagement in Task 4: Identifying Priority Questions and Rigorous Strategies, Task 5: Implementing Quick Turnaround Studies on Emerging Topics of Interest, Task 6: Conducting Focused Literature Reviews and Environmental Scans, Task 7: Supporting the Development and Refinement of Tribal Early Childhood Development Learning Agenda, Task 8: Synthesizing and Translating Research Findings. Additionally, the plan should include explicit discussion of how the independence of research and evaluation functions and findings will be protected from both the appearance and reality of bias throughout the planning for and execution of active engagement. The Contractor shall submit a draft plan to the COR **no later than two (2) months after contract award** and a final deliverable to the COR **no later than three (3) months after contract award**. If appropriate, a Memorandum of Understanding with some individuals and groups may be warranted, particularly in high-stakes evaluations or sensitive relationships. The Contractor's plan shall be updated throughout the project as necessary to document the decisions and agreements made around areas of active engagement.

Task 3: Expert Consultation

In coordination with the COR and additional federal staff, the Contractor shall identify and engage external experts in areas related to actionable research and evaluation and effective communication of findings for Tribal home visiting programs.

Such experts shall provide expert consultation as well as supplement project team expertise in the development of requested products. Activities may include participating in workgroups, reviewing literature reviews, questionnaire drafts, research syntheses, ad hoc papers, briefs, and presentations and other similar activities. For each request for expert consultation and in coordination with the COR and additional federal staff, the Contractor shall identify potential experts from relevant academic, professional consulting, and service-provider and participant communities, with expertise in the specific need of the government. Examples of expertise



include research use; best practices in TA; learning agendas; early childhood home visiting; Tribal early childhood, core components, early childhood workforce. Other areas of required expertise may be identified over the course of this contract. Identification and selection of the experts will occur on an as needed basis and in accordance with a process approved by the COR. Upon COR approval of the expert selection, the Contractor shall contact experts to obtain their consent and availability for agreed upon consultation or work. The Contractor shall contact experts **within two (2) weeks after a specific work request** for consultative services is made by the COR and finalize written agreements with experts **within thirty (30) days after contact** is made, for those experts who agree to the request. The Contractor shall receive written approval from the COR prior to contacting any potential consultants.

Upon execution of any sub-contract or independent consulting agreement, the Contractor shall monitor and manage the successful completion of the agreed upon work. If requested, the Contractor shall provide the COR with a copy of the consultation agreement. The Contractor shall include the timeline of the consultation, including when delivery of the end product(s) of value to the Government will be, in the monthly progress report. The COR may require Consultants to present the results of their work for government information sharing projects or for other purposes. If travel is required for this, the Contractor shall pay the Consultants' transportation and per diem expenses.

Task 4: Identifying Priority Questions and Rigorous Strategies

The Contractor shall develop an overall plan for identifying priority learning questions for ACF's Tribal MIECHV program and for identifying rigorous strategies to answer those questions (e.g., focused literature review, new data collection or secondary analyses, synthesis/translation of research). The most rigorous strategy shall match the question and consider available resources and timelines.

This task shall involve developing and maintaining a dynamic list of prioritized questions and rigorous strategies which will be reviewed and updated with the COR and relevant federal staff on a regular schedule and in response to emerging interest. This task will enable the government to make choices about questions to pursue and to weigh different options.

Active engagement will be critical to this task. Contractor shall submit a draft workplan for identifying priority learning questions and rigorous strategies **no later than three (3) months after contract award. Within two (2) weeks of receiving comments from the COR**, a revised workplan will be submitted to the COR for approval. Once a workplan is approved, the Contractor shall implement the workplan.

The Contractor shall develop an **internal memo**, on a schedule proposed in the workplan, with priority questions and strategies. Upon receipt the COR will review and meet with the contractor to select a priority for implementation. Once the COR has selected a priority, the Contractor shall begin to further plan that strategy in the corresponding task, which includes but may not be limited to, Task 5: Implementing Quick Turnaround Studies, Task 6: Conducting Focused Literature Reviews and Environmental Scans, and Task 7: Synthesizing and Translating Research Findings to Support Practical Application and Use.



Task 5: Implementing Quick Turnaround Studies

As directed by the COR, the contractor shall develop, plan and implement quick turnaround studies that address research questions identified in Task 4. These studies may range in scope, intensity, and mode, depending on federal interest and the topic selected. The contractor shall continue to consult with the COR on the appropriate timeline, magnitude, and medium once a topic and general approach has been identified in Task 4. Example foci that might emerge from active engagement with the Tribal MIECHV program staff, Tribal MIECHV grant recipients, and Native communities include but are not limited to tracking outcomes of program expansion, exploring the feasibility of new program initiatives and/or TA approaches, exploring implementation or measurement questions related to core aspects of Tribal Home Visiting, and conducting secondary analysis of existing data sets to further refine existing measures. The results of a quick turnaround study may be for internal or external use and dissemination, depending on the topic and as determined by the COR.

Subtask 5.1- Quick Turnaround Study Plan

For each study assigned by the COR, the Contractor shall draft a Quick Study Plan designed to address ACF's questions of interest within allocated resources. The Contractor's response shall clearly demonstrate that the Contractor possesses the necessary subject matter, technical, and programmatic expertise to successfully complete the study and the level of resources required to conduct the requested work. The Contractor's initial Plan shall, at minimum:

- Briefly summarize learning questions and goals as relevant context for the study
- Propose a methodology, task structure, deliverables, and a staffing plan designed to achieve ACF's stated goals and objectives of the study
- Identify whether the questions of interest could be analyzed using existing MIECHV administrative or research datasets (with proper approvals) and/or
- Identify efficient modes of primary data collection to reliably answer questions of interest
- Identify whether the activity will require Institutional Review Board (IRB) review and Tribal Research approvals;
- Propose a budget and a timeline for the study;
- Identify potential risks to timely completion within the stated budget, and suggest an approach to their mitigation;
- Request from ACF any additional initial information the Contractor deems necessary for developing a realistic and complete proposal.

The initial Quick Turnaround Study Plan shall be prepared and delivered to the COR **within four (4) weeks of the COR approving a topic**, unless otherwise directed by the COR. Input from ACF shall be incorporated to finalize expectations for the study process, data collection materials, products, and timeline **within three (3) weeks of**



receipt of comments from the COR. The Plan must be approved by the COR, with consent from other relevant federal staff, prior to the commencement of the Quick Turnaround Study Task. If necessary, any modifications to the Quick Turnaround Study Task must receive prior approval by the COR.

Subtask 5.2: Quick Turnaround Study Task

This task shall support the Contractor's implementation of the quick turnaround study as described in the approved proposal. Quick turnaround studies may include, but are not limited to,

- Implementing additional active engagement to refine study plans
- Finalizing data collection materials, protocols, and other related documents
- Conducting or supporting the conduct of data collection activities (focus groups, talking circles, surveys)
- Developing analysis plans for primary or secondary data
- Conducting data quality checks
- Analyzing quantitative and/or qualitative data
- Writing up draft results
- Implementing additional active engagement for interpretation of results
- Drafting internal memos or brief reports summarizing and presenting the results
- Completing any required Tribal Research Review processes for communication of results

The Contractor shall submit any draft and final deliverables (e.g., questions, study designs, data collection materials, analysis plans, outlines, storylines, written summaries, memos, reports) specified in the **Quick Turnaround Study Plan** to the COR for review and approval on a schedule proposed by the Contractor and approved by the COR.

Task 6: Conducting Focused Literature Reviews and Environmental Scans

As directed by the COR, the Contractor shall identify, review, and synthesize literature or resources that are relevant to research questions or topics of interest identified in Task 4 as best pursued through literature review or environmental scan. The literature review(s) should be detailed and seek to identify research gaps and limitations but may not need to be exhaustive. The literature review(s) shall not be duplicative of previous and ongoing efforts, shall build upon the work conducted for MIECHV, and shall appropriately leverage existing reviews (e.g., published reviews by academic scholars, professional organizations, or government-sponsored contractors). Environmental scans may include additional resources not included in the literature review, such as program documents, policy and guidance documents, technical assistance resources, information related to curriculum development, and presentations or publications from related projects and studies. For topics where less is known and where appropriate, the Contractor may augment the review through discussions with key informants. Results of literature review and/or environmental scans may be for internal or external use and dissemination, depending on the topic and as determined by the COR.



Within three (3) weeks of a topic being approved by the COR, the Contractor shall submit a draft workplan for completing the literature review and/or environmental scan. **Within two (2) weeks after receiving comments from the COR**, a revised workplan will be submitted to the COR for approval. Once a workplan is approved, the Contractor shall implement the workplan.

The Contractor shall submit any draft and final deliverables (e.g., outlines, storylines, written summaries) specified in the workplan to the COR for review and approval on a schedule proposed by the Contractor and approved by the COR.

Task 7: Synthesizing and Translating Research Findings to Support Practical Application and Use

To ensure that research findings from this or other MIECHV-funded projects are communicated and useful for decision making and practice, the Contractor shall support MIECHV in the following areas:

- Translating research findings into information that can directly inform MIECHV policy and technical assistance
- Developing practice-ready, tribally relevant products that present translated research findings and can be immediately used to inform decision making and practice
- Coordinating with federal staff, TA staff, or other federal contractors to support the translation of research findings and tailoring dissemination to the desired audiences

The Contractor shall translate findings from but not limited to, projects under this or other MIECHV contracts and grants, and well as external sources. The Contractor shall support application at the federal and grant recipient level. Results produced may be for internal or external use and dissemination, depending on the topic and as determined by the COR.

Within three (3) weeks of the COR requesting support for these activities, the Contractor shall submit a draft workplan. Two (2) weeks after receiving comments from the COR on the plan, a revised workplan will be submitted to the COR for approval. Once a workplan is approved, the Contractor shall implement the workplan.

The Contractor shall submit any draft and final deliverables (e.g., outlines, storylines, written summaries, materials for webinars and office hours) specified in the workplan to the COR for review and approval on a schedule proposed by the Contractor and approved by the COR.

Task 8: Supporting the Development and Refinement of Tribal Early Childhood Development Learning Agenda (supplement to MIECHV Learning Agenda)

A learning agenda is an iterative, dynamic process that supports ongoing, continuous learning about a program with the goal of generating and using evidence to support improvements and future learnings. Learning agendas involve collaboratively (1) identifying critical questions that, when answered, will help programs be more effective, and (2) answering those questions using the most appropriate tools. It is a planned approach to learning and improving program performance through evaluation and analysis. Implementing a learning agenda approach creates an environment that encourages individuals, offices, and teams to reflect on and learn from their



experience and from others. A learning agenda is flexible, and once it is integrated into a processes, can help staff and partners build knowledge in a planful way and learn rapidly to enable iterative course corrections and improvements.

The purpose of this task is to support the development of a supplement to the [MIECHV Learning agenda](#) which was described in the background. The supplement to the MIECHV learning agenda will be focused on implementation of home visiting and other early childhood programs, including but not limited to child care and Head Start, in tribal communities. This Learning Agenda is hereinafter referred to as the Tribal Early Childhood Development Learning Agenda.

The Contractor shall support the COR and other federal staff in the development, continuous maintenance, and refinement of the Tribal Early Childhood Development learning agenda. This may include, but is not limited to, the following activities:

- Review, summarize, and synthesize information across projects and activities using existing materials produced by or about the program. Examples of existing materials include findings from research studies, performance measurement data, and technical assistance needs assessments. The goal of this work is to provide the program with concise summaries of what has been learned to date, to support further analysis and guide future learning and implementation. As needed, work with federal staff and other entities under contract to ACF who are working on the MIECHV Learning Agenda.
- Work with federal staff to determine the scope of new information or materials needed. This may include leading interviews and/or conducting information gathering sessions.
- Create, update, and maintain a process for organizing all materials, both existing and new, that are reviewed.
- Recommend processes to support ongoing summarizing and synthesizing of learnings, including options for how AI, machine learning, and other technologies could be used to help summarize and synthesize. Implement processes approved by the Government.
- Develop new documents as needed that summarize and visually display the information (e.g., briefs, slides) and develop practice-ready products and materials leveraging design and marketing expertise for effective dissemination and revision/updating by end users.
- Coordinate and manage the process of getting input and feedback on learning agenda development, findings and documents created, including helping to lead and participate in meetings of workgroups, engaging in active engagement with program partners, outside experts, program participants and other similar activities.
- Develop a dissemination strategy for the Tribal Early Childhood Development Learning Agenda findings and products. This includes, but is not limited to, working with federal staff to determine audiences (internal and external) and venues, developing messaging plans, and recommending additional products and resources to be developed in the future.

A critical component of the learning agenda work will be active engagement – with federal staff, especially program partners, and with a diverse array of external experts (e.g., tribal program administrators, tribal leadership, local program staff, individuals and families who participate or participated in the programs, model developers, researchers, and evaluators, etc.). The purpose of



this active engagement is to ensure that (1) the learning agenda reflects the cross-cutting priorities of Tribal Early Childhood Development and the broader field; (2) useful information is being produced that helps to improve the program and that is being shared in ways that make it easy to use the information; and (3) information is gathered in an ongoing way to inform future updates and revisions to the learning agenda.

Subtask 8.1: Develop Learning Agenda Plan

The Contractor shall develop a plan for carrying out learning agenda activities. This shall involve working with the COR and other federal staff to help identify which activities will be needed under the Base and developing timelines and a workplan for carrying them out. The Contractor shall ensure that the Learning Agenda plan and Active Engagement plan complement each other.

The Contractor shall submit a draft plan within five (5) months of contract award and a revised plan within three (3) weeks after receiving comments from the COR. The plan will be considered a living document, which may require updates over the course of the Base. Any updates will be conducted on a schedule proposed by the Contractor and approved by the COR.

Subtask 8.2. Implementation of the Learning Agenda Plan

The Contractor shall implement all activities in the COR-approved Learning Agenda Plan in Subtask 8.1. The Contractor shall submit any draft and final deliverables in the Learning Agenda Plan to the COR for review and approval on a schedule proposed by the Contractor and approved by the COR.

Task 9: External Communication

Subtask 9.1 Develop External Communication Plan

ACF wants information about and findings from its research and evaluation projects to be shared with relevant audiences throughout the course of the project. The Contractor shall develop an external communication plan for this project that describes:

Overarching project communication goals;

- Key types of information the project expects to convey (e.g. project site selection; project implementation findings; interim impact findings; etc.) and projected timeline for when this information will be available;
- Key audiences for different types of project information;
- A detailed strategy – including proposed products – for communicating specific information to specific audiences;
- Communication resources (e.g. staff, budget);
- Metrics that will be used to gauge the impact of communication activities and a plan for collecting and analyzing metrics and applying insights;
- A plan for coordinating with and amplifying OPRE external communication efforts;



- A schedule for revisiting the communication plan throughout the project's duration, tracking progress on the plan, and revising as necessary; and
- A schedule for COR review of communication deliverables.

Examples of external communication products may include, but are not limited to:

- Introductions or announcements of project and project participants
- Project newsletters
- Conference presentations
- Interim and final reports
- Briefs
- Special topics reports
- Briefings to ACF and/or other relevant policy officials or program administrators
- Scholarly journal articles
- Technical papers/memoranda
- Blog posts for release on the OPRE Insights Blog and other blogs
- Videos
- Data visualizations
- Infographics
- Social media content
- Other multimedia content

Contractors are expected to coordinate with and amplify OPRE communication efforts related to this project, which will likely at a minimum include posting deliverables on the OPRE website and sharing project information via OPRE's [social media accounts](#) and via OPRE News. OPRE encourages the Contractor to reciprocally engage with and otherwise amplify project content shared by ACF and OPRE social media accounts. OPRE also encourages the Contractor to share project information on its own channels (e.g. social media, newsletter, blog, etc.); project information disseminated by the Contractor shall be reviewed and approved in advance by the COR.

ACF encourages innovative approaches to research communication and outreach. To the extent possible, the Contractor shall apply modern best practices to the development of all external communication products. All deliverables shall be compatible with the ACF website and other ACF and OPRE communication platforms. Before work begins on web-based or other multimedia content the Contractor shall consult with the COR and other relevant ACF communications staff to ensure computability.

The Contractor shall ensure that *all* external communication products meet or exceed Section 508 compliancy standards. Materials needed to make multimedia content 508 compliant, including but not limited to .srt caption files and alt text, shall be delivered to the COR as a component of the final deliverable package. At a minimum all written deliverables must pass an Adobe Acrobat accessibility check, and the Contractor shall deliver verification of this check to the COR as a component of the final deliverable package. For written deliverables the Contractor



shall use a clear and consistent heading and tagging scheme, provide human-generated descriptive alt text for all images and graphics, use simple formatting in tables (i.e. no merged cells, multiple simple tables vs. complex tables). Any deliverable submitted to the Contractor that is not 508 compliant is subject to rejection or to be returned to the Contractor for remediation.

The contractor shall ensure that *all* written components of deliverables meet federal plain language guidelines (<https://plainlanguage.gov/media/FederalPLGuidelines.pdf>). Plain language is a priority for ACF to ensure that deliverables created are clear, accessible, and useful to relevant audiences. Any deliverables that do not adhere to the Plain Language Guidelines will be returned to the Contractor for revision.

Reports exceeding 15 pages shall include a 1-2 page overview section written in plain language, highlighting the key findings. Longer reports may also require an executive summary, at the direction of the COR. Highly technical materials shall usually be placed in appendices. In addition, the Contractor shall adhere to OPRE's requirements regarding the publication of documents, including formatting, inclusion of the OPRE logo, the OPRE report number, and inclusion of other important information. Documents that do not meet OPRE's guidelines will not be approved for release. The COR will provide these guidelines to the Contractor upon award.

OPRE reserves the right to request that the Contractor submit contract deliverables for independent or external review. This request may come at the time of development of the external communication plan or as products are developed. If independent or external review of deliverables is requested by OPRE, the COR will provide additional information about the structure and nature of this peer review.

The Contractor shall submit a draft external communication plan to the COR no later than 6 months following award of the contract. A final plan shall be submitted within two (2) weeks of receipt of feedback from the COR. Deviations from the final plan require prior approval of the COR.

Subtask 9.2: Develop Project Description

The Contractor shall develop a brief, one- or two-page Project Description for use by the Contractor and ACF/OPRE that provides an overview of the project and communicates the purpose of the project. The first draft of the project description shall be submitted to the COR no later than one week after the project orientation. The Contractor shall revise the draft project description based on COR feedback and shall submit a revised document on a schedule proposed by the contractor and approved by the COR. The Contractor shall update the project description over the course of the contract at the request of the COR in order to ensure that the project description adequately provides up-to-date information about the project.

Subtask 9.3: Cover Sheet for all Written Deliverables



To help support ACF's understanding of how documents are produced, the Contractor shall develop a document coversheet for use when submitting drafts of deliverables prepared for publication. The cover sheet shall identify, at minimum, the following information:

- The version of the document (draft, first round of revisions, etc.)
- The lead authors of the deliverable
- Additional staff involved with editing or reviewing the document
- The level of effort from each staff person
- Whether the deliverable is consistent with OPRE guidelines reflected in the OPRE Clear Communication Checklist (attached)

Subtask 9.4: Ongoing External Communication Activities

Ongoing and continuous activities are essential to a strong communication approach for the base and the project more broadly. The Contractor shall undertake activities necessary to meet the goals of the project's external communication plan. The nature and frequency of these activities will be determined in communication with the COR based on the approved communication plan. The Contractor shall submit draft and final external communication products to the COR for review and approval on a schedule proposed by the Contractor and approved by the COR.

Task 10: Office of Management and Budget (OMB) Clearance for Data Collection

The Contractor shall prepare the required Federal Register Notices (FRNs) and information collection request materials for submission to OMB well in advance of the planned initiation of the work, allowing at least 240 days for the clearance process (to include ACF review through OMB approval). The timing of this package may be discussed during the initial project discussion (Task 1). The Contractor shall submit draft instruments and 30- and 60-day FRNs to the COR for review and approval. After the Contractor makes any changes recommended by the COR, ACF will submit the FRNs and instruments to ACF and HHS leadership for review. The Contractor shall submit a draft OMB justification package to the COR for review and approval. After the Contractor makes any changes recommended by the COR, ACF will submit the final package to OMB. The Contractor shall address comments received from OMB and revise materials as needed until approval is received from OMB. Submission and revision of these materials shall take place on **a schedule to be proposed by the Contractor and approved by the COR** and allow sufficient time (e.g., at least 240 calendar days) for the review and disposition of the package by OMB before data collection is schedule to begin.

If clearance related to one of OPRE's Generic Clearances (Formative Data Collections for ACF Research, Formative Data Collections for Program Support, or Pre-testing of Evaluation Data Collection Activities) is required, the contractor shall allow at least 45 days for the clearance



process (from the time of OPRE approval of generic clearance package). Federal Register notices are not required.

For generic clearance packages, the Contractor shall submit a draft OMB justification package (including data collection instruments) to the COR(s) for review and approval **no later than four (4) months prior to when data collection is expected to begin**. After the Contractor makes any changes recommended by the COR(s), ACF will submit the final package to OMB. The contractor shall address comments received from OMB and revise materials as needed until approval is received from OMB.

Institutional Review Board (IRB) approval is needed to ensure that human subjects are protected. The Contractor shall submit draft IRB materials to the COR for review **no later than four (4) weeks before materials are due to the firm's IRB**. The schedule for submission of these materials shall be determined based on the progress of the project and with the COR's approval. **Within two (2) weeks** of receipt of the COR's comments, the Contractor shall provide revised, final materials to the COR that will then be submitted to their IRB. The Contractor shall provide the COR with a copy of the final, approved IRB materials, and shall alert the COR about any substantive changes to the packages within **one (1) weeks** of making such changes.

If appropriate, ACF may require the Contractor to submit draft materials before they are submitted to NIH. As part of their proposal for the Certificate of Confidentiality, the Contractor must have approval from an IRB.

Task 11: Privacy and Data Security Activities and Monitoring

ACF is committed to ensuring that Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI) are appropriately maintained consistent with applicable laws and regulations until the point that it is destroyed according to the most recent versions of National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Special Publication (SP) 800-88 required by HHS/ACF. This includes, but is not limited to: Executive Orders; Privacy Act of 1974; Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA); Federal Information Security Management Act of 2002 (FISMA); Freedom of Information Act of 1974; Federal Records Management Act; NIST SPs; OMB Circulars and Memoranda; Government Accounting Office (GAO) guidance; HHS/ACF Rules and Guidance; and Department of Defense's Defense Intelligence Security Agency Security Technical Implementation Guide (DISA STIG) Hardening Guidelines. To meet this expectation, the Contractor shall undertake appropriate activities to maintain the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of all CUI. This includes (a) following the relevant policies, procedures, controls, and standards required by the HHS/ACF Information Security Program and (b) using any applicable templates, policies, forms, and other agency documents.

Depending on the type and nature of the CUI collected (determined in conjunction with the COR and after review of the Privacy Impact Assessment (PIA) or equivalent document), the Contractor may be required to store the CUI in an environment that requires an Authority to Operate (ATO). If the Contractor does not have an environment with an ATO, but is determined



to need one, they shall plan to secure one and **submit that plan, including alternative options, to the COR on a schedule determined after the PIA or equivalent document has been completed.** The Contractor should choose the most efficient and effective method in consultation with the COR and related ACF staff. Should the Contractor be required to secure an ATO, the Contractor shall achieve compliance with HHS/ACF standards, meaning the Contractor shall create and supply any necessary Security Authorization Documents (based on NIST Risk Management Framework and associated guidance), and participate in the ACF OCIO Governance Systems Development Life Cycle (SDLC) process.

As directed by the COR, the Contractor shall complete the privacy, security, and related trainings required by HHS/ACF, then provide to the COR the certificates of completion for each training. This may include Contractor Information Security Awareness, Privacy, and Records Management training.

Task 12: ATO Requirement

Based on the type and nature of CUI this contract may involve, the Contractor may be required to store the CUI in an environment that requires an Authority to Operate (ATO).

This ATO shall require the Contractor to achieve and maintain compliance with the recent versions of the following documents as required by HHS/ACF: NIST SP 800-18; FIPS 199; FIPS 200; NIST SP 800-53; DISA STIG; SP 800-171; OMB Memorandum M-05-22; and other applicable NIST, HHS, and ACF policies and guidance.

The COR may not be able to determine whether an ATO is required until after the Contractor provides a PIA or equivalent document and/or DSP in the Base 1, Task 11. If the COR does determine that an ATO is required, **within 30 days**, the Contractor shall begin working with the COR to develop a plan and complete all necessary documentation and steps to acquire an ATO. ACF anticipates the process for completing the ATO to be 6 months.

Task 13: Prepare Materials for Transition at the End of the Contract

The Contractor shall assure a smooth transition of the information gained under this task order to COR, or other HHS agent, including other organizations under contract to HHS. This includes all files, software, architecture, programming, codes, analysis tools, databases, forms, reports, search engine features, and all other features and supporting documentation prepared for or purchased as part of this contract. The Contractor shall provide all software, databases

OPTIONS

In addition to the services outlined above, ACF may elect to exercise any or all of the options outlined below at any time during the period of performance.

OPTION 1



Purpose: The purposes of this option are to plan, support, and implement research and evaluation that answers questions of interest to Tribal home visiting programs that support decision making and practice. The activities may include supporting research-practice partnerships and communication about results.

End Product of Value: Final reports for Research-Practice Partnerships

The Contractor shall be responsible for:

Task 1: Project Management and Team Communication

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as SC1-Task 1 (Project Communication and Management) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities to this Services Component.

Task 2: Revise and Implement Active Engagement Approach

This task entails updating the Active Engagement Plan developed under Base-Task 2, if necessary. Otherwise, the description of this task and the list of associated deliverables are the same as the description and the associated deliverables for Base-Task 2 (Active Engagement Approach and Planning) and will not be repeated here.

Task 3: Expert Consultations

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 3 (Expert Consultations) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.

Task 4. Supporting Research-Practice Partnership Studies

ACF aims to support research and evaluation efforts that are driven by the priorities of Native communities and which answer questions that help Tribal Home Visiting programs in decision making or practice improvement. ACF aims to build off of the infrastructure and materials developed through the CIRCLE-HV contract for developing requests for proposals Research-Practice Partnerships (RPPs) and then selecting and supporting RPPs to conduct their studies.

Within three (3) months of the orientation of this option, the Contractor shall submit a draft workplan for the RPPs. The workplan shall include, but is not limited to, plans for a request for proposals, review and selection process, and plan for supporting RPPs through partnership development and study design phase and study implementation and reporting phase, and proposed interim deliverables and final reports for the RPPs. **Within two (2) weeks of receiving comments from the COR** on the plan, a revised workplan will be submitted to the COR for approval. Once a workplan is approved, the Contractor shall implement the workplan.



The Contractor shall submit any draft and final deliverables (e.g., interim reports, presentations) specified in the workplan to the COR for review and approval on a schedule proposed by the Contractor and approved by the COR.

Task 5: Conducting Literature Reviews and Environmental Scans

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 6 (Conducting Literature Reviews and Environmental Scans) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.

Task 6: Synthesizing and Translating Research Findings to Support Practical Application and Use

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 7 (Synthesizing and Translating Research Findings to Support Practical Application and Use) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.

Task 7: Ongoing External Communication Activities

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 9 (External Communication) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.

Task 8: Office of Management and Budget (OMB) and Institutional Review Board (IRB) Clearances for Data Collection

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 10 (Office of Management and Budget (OMB) and Institutional Review Board (IRB) Clearances for Data Collection) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.

Task 9: Ongoing Privacy and Data Security Activities and Monitoring

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 11: Privacy and Data Security Activities and Monitoring

As directed by the COR, the Contractor shall complete the privacy, security, and related trainings required by HHSACF, then provide to the COR certificates of completion for each training. This may include Contractor Information Security Awareness, Privacy, and Records Management training.

OPTIONS

In addition to the services outlined above ACF may elect to exercise the Option below up to two times, resulting in multiple Optional Periods during the period of performance.



OPTION 2-3

Purpose: The purpose of this Option is to plan, support, and implement actionable research and evaluation to answer questions of interest to ACF's Tribal MIECHV program and to effectively translate and communicate these research findings for decision making and practice at the federal and grant recipient level.

End Product of Value: A memo listing all products, engagements, dissemination efforts, and other activities that have been conducted to plan and support actionable research and evaluation and translation of findings for ACF's Tribal MIECHV. This memo shall be a comprehensive listing of all products conducted in the Option Period.

The Contractor shall be responsible for:

Task 1: Project Management and Team Communication

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as SC1-Task 1 (Project Communication and Management) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities to this Services Component.

Task 2: Revise and Implement Active Engagement Approach

This task entails updating the Active Engagement Plan developed under Base-Task 2, if necessary. Otherwise, the description of this task and the list of associated deliverables are the same as the description and the associated deliverables for Base-Task 2 (Active Engagement Approach and Planning) and will not be repeated here.

Task 3: Expert Consultations

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 3 (Expert Consultations) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.

Task 4: Identifying Priority Questions and Rigorous Strategies

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 4 (Identifying Priority Questions and Rigorous Strategies) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.

Task 5: Implementing Quick Turnaround Studies on Emerging Topics of Interest

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 5: Implementing Quick Turnaround Studies on Emerging Topics of Interest and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.

Task 6: Conducting Literature Reviews and Environmental Scans



The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 6 (Conducting Literature Reviews and Environmental Scans) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.

Task 7: Synthesizing and Translating Research Findings.

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 9 (**Synthesizing and Translating Research Findings to Support Practical Application and Use**) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.

Task 8: Ongoing External Communication Activities

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 5 (External Communication) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.

Task 9: Office of Management and Budget (OMB) and Institutional Review Board (IRB) Clearances for Data Collection

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 10 (Office of Management and Budget (OMB) and Institutional Review Board (IRB) Clearances for Data Collection) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.

Task 10: Ongoing Privacy and Data Security Activities and Monitoring

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base

The Contractor shall adhere to the statements made in the PIA or equivalent document developed according to the Base, Task X. The Contractor shall follow these procedures and statements for all data activities included as part of this option.

As directed by the COR, the Contractor shall complete the privacy, security, and related trainings required by HHSACF, then provide to the COR certificates of completion for each training. This may include Contractor Information Security Awareness, Privacy, and Records Management training.

Task 11: ATO Requirement

The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 12 (ATO Requirement) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.



3.0 Background Checks

- The Contractor shall conduct background checks prior to being permitted to work on the project and every 5 years after in compliance with the Fair Credit Reporting Act. This is a requirement for all contractor/subcontractor employees working on this contract that may have contact with or manage information regarding vulnerable populations, children, and/or youth in their homes or programs. These individuals include but are not limited to, data collectors, on-site coaches, trainers, etc. In addition, the proposed hire shall complete a “Basic Criminal History and Statement of Admission” during this background check and then annually update if anything has changed in their history that might change the results of their background check. This information shall be provided to the designated CO and COR if the result adversely impacts suitability.
- Contractors are strongly encouraged to set up [Rap Back systems](#) to receive automatic alerts if information on a currently employed individual changes in-between formal checks.
- Background checks shall include at minimum FBI Next Generation Information (NGI) criminal history repository and National Crime Information Center (NCIC) National Sex Offender Registry (NSOR) checks. All criminal history checks must use fingerprints if that is an option and otherwise can be name based.
- Disqualifying offenses include, but are not limited to:
 - Refusal to consent to background check
 - Knowingly making a materially false statement in connection with such criminal background check
 - Is registered, or is required to be registered, on a state sex offender registry or repository, or the National Sex Offender Registry
 - Has been convicted of a felony consisting of murder, spousal abuse, child abuse or neglect, crime against children, including child pornography, crime involving rape or sexual assault, kidnapping, arson, physical assault or battery or drug related offenses.
 - Has been convicted of a violent misdemeanor committed as an adult against a child, including the following crimes: child abuse, child endangerment, sexual assault, or of a misdemeanor involving child pornography.
- Should the background check indicate a positive result for any of the sources, the contractor shall notify the designated CO and COR within 2 business days for determination of suitability. In addition, the contractor shall investigate the nature of the offense, the age of conviction, and the time since the offense occurred and provide a



written justification if the intent is to move forward with having the individual work on the project.

- The strictest standard shall be used for individuals engaged in direct in-person data collection or fieldwork that may encounter vulnerable populations, including adults where children may be present, children, youth or other vulnerable populations and managing information about such vulnerable populations.
- Contractors must complete the full background check process and review prior to the individual's initiating work on the contract. Contractors may provisionally staff a prospective staff member on the project after receiving the results of the fingerprint-based FBI criminal history check. These individuals must be accompanied by fully vetted and cleared supervisory staff on all field assignments until the full background check is completed, especially in situations where children or youth may be physically present.

4.0 Contractor Quality Assurance.

The Government intends to utilize a Quality Assurance Surveillance Plan (QASP) to monitor the quality of the Contractor's performance for the life of the contract. In addition to the general oversight provided in the contract, the QASP will provide performance metrics help to ensure that service levels reach and maintain the required levels throughout the contract term. Further, the QASP provides the COR with a proactive way to avoid unacceptable or deficient performance and provides verifiable input for the required Past Performance Information Assessments. The QASP is a living document and may be updated as necessary for the life of the contract.

The Contractor shall review the attached QASP (ATTACHMENT X) and shall submit comments within 30 calendar days after order award for COR review. The contract's performance requirements are dictated by the QASP.



5.0 Delivery or Deliverables

Table 1 Table of Deliverables

PWS Task #	Deliverable Title	Frequency and Due Date	Acceptance Criteria
Task 1: Project Management and Team Communication	Orientation, including agenda and relevant materials	At least 3 business days before meeting	Timely scheduling and relevant materials. Review and revisions to occur on schedule to be agreed upon with COR if needed.
	Ongoing call agendas	No less than 3 working days in advance of meeting	Thorough agenda detailing all items to be discussed
	Call Summary	No more than 5 working days following meeting	Comprehensive details of primary discussion points and action items. Review and revisions to occur on schedule to be agreed upon with COR if needed.
	Monthly Progress Reports	On a scheduled agreed upon with the COR	Comprehensive details of the activities completed and progress for each task for the report month, expenditure data by task, balance remaining, and details related to project performance
Task 2: Active Engagement Plan	Active Engagement Plan	No later than two (2) months after contract award and a final deliverable to the COR no later than three (3) months after contract award.	Clearly articulated approach to authentic and comprehensive active engagement at every stage of the project, including the reason for inclusion of the individuals and groups proposed to be engaged, how and when they will be engaged, and how input will be addressed and incorporated to achieve the purpose of the study.



Task 3: Expert Consultations	Contact experts and obtain written agreements	Contact experts within 2 weeks after a specific work request for consultative services is made by the COR and finalize written agreements with experts within 30 days after contact is made	Timely agreements made with expert consultants; successful completion of the agreed upon work, monitored, and managed by the Contractor.
Task 4: Identifying Priority Questions and Rigorous Strategies	Priority Question and Strategies Workplan	Draft no later than three (3) months after contract award and a final draft within two (2) weeks after receiving comments from the COR.	Clearly articulated approach to identifying priority learning questions, strategies for addressing these questions, and a plan for updating this list and facilitating the selection of topics to pursue on an ongoing basis.
	Implementation of Priority Question and Strategies Workplan	On a schedule proposed in the workplan	Implementation that aligns with the processes outlined in the plan.
	Priority Question and Strategies Workplan Internal Memo	On a schedule proposed in the workplan	Comprehensive list of prioritized questions and rigorous strategies to pursue those questions with recommendations to the government
Task 5: Implementing Quick Turnaround Studies	Quick Turnaround Study Plan	Draft within four weeks of topic being approved, unless otherwise directed by the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR), and the final within 3 weeks of receiving comments from the COR	Clearly articulated study plan includes learning questions, proposed methodology, task structure, deliverables, staffing plan, and realistic budget and timeline.
	Quick Turnaround Study Task	On a schedule to be agreed upon with COR	Implementation that aligns with the processes outlined in the plan.



	Deliverables outlined in the Quick Turnaround Study Plan	On a schedule to be agreed upon with COR	Implementation that aligns with processes outlined in the Plan, and products that adhere to OPRE's quality standards
Task 6: Focused Literature Reviews and Environmental Scans	Literature Reviews and Environmental Scan Workplan	Draft within 3 weeks of a topic being approved by the COR, and final draft within 2 weeks after receiving comments from the COR.	Clearly articulated plan for carrying out the literature review and/or environmental scan
	Deliverables outlined in the Literature Reviews and Environmental Scan Workplan	On a schedule proposed by the Contractor and approved by the COR.	implementation that aligns with processes outlined in the Plan, and products that adhere to OPRE's quality standards
Task 7: Synthesizing and Translating Research Findings to Support Practical Application and Use	Research Synthesis and Translation Workplan	Draft within 3 weeks of request from COR, and final draft within 2 weeks of receiving comments.	Clearly articulated approach to research to practice translation activities and activities to support practical application and use of research findings.
	Deliverables outlined in the Research Synthesis and Translation Workplan	On a schedule to be agreed upon with COR	Implementation that aligns with work outlined in the Plan, and products that adhere to OPRE's quality standards
Task 8: Tribal Early Childhood Development Learning Agenda	Learning Agenda Plan	Draft within five (5) months of contract award, final plan within 3 weeks of receipt of COR's comments.	Clearly articulated plan for carrying out learning agenda activities, including who should be included, existing materials that can be synthesized, additional information needed, a plan for developing a visual, a dissemination strategy, and clear alignment with the MIECHV Learning Agenda work to date and Active Engagement plan.
	Implementation of the Learning Agenda Plan	On a schedule to be agreed upon with COR	Implementation that aligns with the core principles outlined in the plan.



Task 9: External Communication	Subtask 9.1 Develop External Communication Plan	Draft no later than 6 months following contract award, final plan within 2 weeks of receipt of COR's comments.	Innovative communication plan that adheres to the expectations laid out in Task 9 and maximizes reach to a wide variety of audiences
	Subtask 9.2: Develop Project Description	No later than one week after project orientation	Clear overview of the project and its purpose
	Subtask 9.3: Cover Sheet for all Written Deliverables	Due in conjunction with all written deliverables at the request of the COR.	Coversheet that clearly outlines pertinent information about the deliverable that adheres to the standards set out in Task 9
	Subtask 9.4: Ongoing External Communication Activities	On a schedule proposed by the Contractor and approved by the COR.	Implementation of activities that are consistent with the plans and standards laid out in the plan developed under Subtask 9.1
Task 10: Office of Management and Budget (OMB) Clearance for Data Collection	Submission and Revision of OMB Materials	On a schedule proposed by the Contractor and approved by the COR.	Complete package incorporating feedback received through other project tasks with all necessary components needed for submission to OMB
	Submission and Revision of IRB Materials	Draft no later than 4 weeks before materials are due to the firm's IRB, final materials due within 2 weeks of receipt of the COR's comments, and alert COR about any substantive changes to the materials within 1 week of making such changes	Complete package incorporating feedback received through other project tasks with all necessary components needed for submission to IRB
Task 11: Privacy and Data Security Activities and Monitoring	Privacy Impact Assessment (PIA)	On a schedule to be agreed upon with the COR, but at least 30 days before the submission of the OMB package	Complete and thorough documentation of privacy impacts.



	Data Security Plan	On a schedule to be agreed upon with the COR, but at least 30 days before the submission of the OMB package	Complete and thorough documentation of data security measures
Task 12: ATO Requirement	ATO plan	On a schedule to be agreed upon with the COR.	Complete and thorough plan for conducting an ATO if needed.
	Begin documentation for ATO process	On a schedule to be agreed upon with the COR, within 30 days of determination that an ATO is required.	Completion of all steps necessary for obtaining an ATO, in consultation with the COR.
Task 13: Prepare Materials for Transition at the End of the Services Component	Materials and any necessary training	3 weeks before end of contract.	Comprehensive accounting and timely transfer of all materials and trainings needed to continue management as outlined in Task
OPTION 1 (OPTIONAL PERIOD 1)			
Task 1: Project Management and Team Communication	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as SC1-Task 1 (Project Communication and Management) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities to this Services Component.		
Task 2: Revise Engagement Approach	This task entails updating the Active Engagement Plan developed under Base-Task 2, if necessary. Otherwise, the description of this task and the list of associated deliverables are the same as the description and the associated deliverables for Base-Task 2 (Active Engagement Approach Plan) and will not be repeated here.		



Task 3: Expert Consultations	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 3 (Expert Consultations) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.		
Task 4. Supporting Research-Practice Partnership Studies	Workplan for Research-Practice Partnership	Within 3 months of orientation, revised draft due within 2 weeks of COR comments	Clearly articulated approach for selection and supporting research partnerships that address questions of interest to Tribal Home Visiting Programs
	Deliverables as outlined in the approved Research-Practice Partnerships Work Plan	On a schedule to be agreed upon with COR	Implementation that aligns with work outlined in the Plan, and products that adhere to OPRE's quality standards
Task 5: Conducting Literature Reviews and Environmental Scans	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 6 (Conducting Literature Reviews and Environmental Scans) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.		
Task 6: Synthesizing and Translating Research Findings to Support Practical Application and Use	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 7 (Synthesizing and Translating Research Findings to Support Practical Application and Use) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.		
Task 7: Ongoing External Communication Activities	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 9 (External Communication) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.		



Task 8: Office of Management and Budget (OMB) and Institutional Review Board (IRB) Clearances for Data Collection	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 10 (Office of Management and Budget (OMB) and Institutional Review Board (IRB) Clearances for Data Collection) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.
Task 9: Ongoing Privacy and Data Security Activities and Monitoring	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 11: Privacy and Data Security Activities and Monitoring
Optional Period 2-3	
Task 1: Project Management and Team Communication	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as SC1-Task 1 (Project Communication and Management) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities to this Services Component.
Task 2: Revise Engagement Approach	This task entails updating the Active Engagement Plan developed under Base-Task 2, if necessary. Otherwise, the description of this task and the list of associated deliverables are the same as the description and the associated deliverables for Base-Task 2 (Active Engagement Approach Plan) and will not be repeated here.
Task 3: Expert Consultations	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 3 (Expert Consultations) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.
Task 4: Identifying Priority Questions and Rigorous Strategies	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 4 (Identifying Priority Questions and Rigorous Strategies) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.



Task 5: Implementing Quick Turnaround Studies on Emerging Topics of Interest	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 5: Implementing Quick Turnaround Studies on Emerging Topics of Interest and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.
Task 6: Conducting Literature Reviews and Environmental Scans	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 6 (Conducting Literature Reviews and Environmental Scans) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.
Task 7: Synthesizing and Translating Research Findings to Support Practical Application and Use	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 7 (Synthesizing and Translating Research Findings to Support Practical Application and Use) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.
Task 8: Ongoing External Communication Activities	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 9 (External Communication) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.
Task 9: Office of Management and Budget (OMB) and Institutional Review Board (IRB) Clearances for Data Collection	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 10 (Office of Management and Budget (OMB) and Institutional Review Board (IRB) Clearances for Data Collection) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.
Task 10: Ongoing Privacy and Data Security Activities and Monitoring	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base Task 11: Privacy and Data Security Activities and Monitoring



Task 11: ATO Requirement	The description of this task, including subtasks and associated deliverables, is the same as Base-Task 12 (ATO Requirement) and will not be repeated here. The task shall be focused on the goals and activities of this Option.
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Notice to contractors:

All information and data related to this project that the contractor gathers or obtains will be both protected from unauthorized release and considered the property of the government. The contracting officer will be the sole authorized official to release verbally or in writing any data, draft deliverables, final deliverables, or any other written or printed materials pertaining to this contract.

Press releases, marketing material, or any other printed or electronic documentation related to this project must not be publicized without the written approval of the contracting officer.

6.0 Required Travel and Other Direct Costs (ODCs)

Contract-related travel expenses may include expenses related to conduct data collection activities, attending active engagement or expert convenings, attending conferences and disseminating findings. In coordination with the COR, the contractor must request approval for travel expenses at least three (3) weeks in advance of the intended departure date.

Contractor costs for travel will be reimbursed at the limits set in the following regulations (see FAR 31.205-46):

- a) Federal Travel Regulation (FTR) - for travel in the contiguous United States (U.S.).**
- b) Joint Travel Regulations (JTR) Volume 2, Department of Defense (DoD) Civilian Personnel, Appendix A – prescribed by the DoD for travel to Alaska, Hawaii, and outlying areas of the U.S.**

The contractor may invoice monthly on the basis of cost incurred for cost of travel comparable with the FTR. The invoice shall include the period of performance covered by the invoice, the CLIN number and title. Separate worksheets, in MS Excel format, shall be submitted for travel.

CLIN Total Travel: This invoice information shall identify all cumulative travel costs billed by CLIN. The current invoice period's travel details shall include separate columns and totals and include the following:



- a) Travel Authorization Request identifier, approver name, and approval date
- b) Current invoice period
- c) Names of persons traveling
- d) Number of travel days
- e) Dates of travel
- f) Number of days per diem charged.
- g) Per diem rate used
- h) Total per diem charged.
- i) Transportation costs (rental car, airfare, etc.)
- j) Total charges
- k) Explanation of variances exceed ten percent of the approved versus actual costs

7.0 Special Instructions

The Contractor shall ensure that all external communication products meet or exceed Section 508 compliancy standards. Materials needed to make multimedia content 508 compliant, including but not limited to .srt caption files and alt text, shall be delivered to the COR as a component of the final deliverable package. At a minimum all written deliverables must pass an Adobe Acrobat accessibility check, and the Contractor shall deliver verification of this check to the COR as a component of the final deliverable package. For written deliverables the Contractor shall use a clear and consistent heading and tagging scheme, provide human-generated descriptive alt text for all images and graphics, use simple formatting in tables (i.e., no merged cells, multiple simple tables vs. complex tables). Any deliverable submitted to the Contractor that is not 508 compliant is subject to rejection or to be returned to the Contractor for remediation.

Section 508 and Accessibility Standards

Section 508 of the Rehabilitation Act, as amended by the Workforce Investment Act of 1998 (P.L. 105-220), requires Information and Communications Technology (ICT) to be accessible to people with disabilities when Federal agencies develop, procure, maintain, or use ICT. Federal employees and members of the public with disabilities must have access to and use of information and data comparable to people without disabilities.



All products, platforms, and services delivered as part of this work statement that are ICT, or contain ICT, must conform to the Revised 508 Standards, which are located at 36 C.F.R. § 1194.1 & Apps. A, B, C, & D, and available at <https://www.access-board.gov/ict/>. All requirements are applicable to support services and documentation deliverables. All functional performance criteria apply when using an alternative design or technology that achieves substantially equivalent or greater accessibility and usability by individuals with disabilities than would be provided by conformance to one or more of the requirements in Chapters 4-6 of the Revised 508 Standards, or when Chapters 4-6 do not address one or more functions of ICT.

A fully completed Accessibility Conformance Report (ACR) using the Voluntary Product Accessibility Template (VPAT) (<https://www.itic.org/policy/accessibility/vpat>) must be submitted for each proposed product, platform, or service. Evaluation of the VPAT will be on an Acceptable/Unacceptable basis.

Prior to acceptance of deliverables, the offeror must demonstrate conformance with the ACF Section 508 requirements via the applicable ACF Section 508 checklist(s) (<https://connect.acf.hhs.gov/rights-responsibilities/section-508>) and/or <https://connect.acf.hhs.gov/tech/section-508> Section 508 | ACF Connect (hhs.gov). The Government reserves the right to perform testing on required ICT items to validate the offeror's Section 508 conformance claims. If the Government determines the Section 508 conformance does not meet the ACF Section 508 requirements, the Government shall, at its option, require the offeror to remediate the item, at no additional cost to the Government, to align with the ACF Section 508 conformance requirements, before acceptance.

8.0 Government Furnished Property/Equipment/Information

If it is deemed necessary, the contractor will have access to GFI via PIV Cards and other Government Furnished Equipment (GFE). All necessary security protocols will be followed and documented to ensure compliance with regulations